

LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF IDAHO
Sixty-eighth Legislature Second Regular Session - 2026

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
HOUSE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 37

BY CAYLER

A CONCURRENT RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE LEGISLATURE AND ENCOURAGING THE STATE TO REJECT AND
RETURN ANY FUNDS ASSOCIATED WITH THE RURAL HEALTH TRANSFORMATION PRO-
GRAM.

Be It Resolved by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, in February 2026, the Senate Health and Welfare Committee
passed Senate Bill No. 1264, and in March 2026, the House Health and Welfare
Committee passed House Bill No. 862. Both of these bills employ similar
language to set up the Idaho Rural Health Transformation Fund in the state
treasury. The language in these bills creates a new Chapter 25 in Title 56,
Idaho Code, and Section 56-2501 of the proposed new chapter states in part,
"The fund shall consist of moneys received by the state of Idaho from the
federal rural health transformation program grant and such other moneys that
may be provided by legislative appropriation."; and

WHEREAS, Idaho is to receive approximately \$1 billion from the federal
government for the Rural Health Transformation Fund. And as stated when
Idaho accepted American Rescue Plan Act funds in 2021, this money is borrowed
from our grandchildren. These borrowed funds for rural health were secured
to gain key congressional votes to secure the passage of the One Big Beauti-
ful Bill Act; and

WHEREAS, the United States already spends over \$15,000 per person on
health care or 18% of gross domestic product, more than any other high income
nation. Throwing more federal money into the system will not improve rural
health, but rather just further increase health care inflation; and

WHEREAS, these funds must be used within the parameters of the federally
approved Idaho plan limiting state flexibility; and

WHEREAS, Idaho does not have to accept these funds just because they
were awarded to the state.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Ses-
sion of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the House of Representatives and
the Senate concurring therein, that the Legislature strongly encourages the
Joint Finance-Appropriations Committee not to appropriate any funds associ-
ated with the Rural Health Transformation Program.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature strongly encourages the
State Treasurer to return any and all funds associated with the Rural Health
Transformation Program to the United States Treasury, whose debt is nearly
\$39 trillion.